VCT CONNECT

Integrated Project Plan

Planning period: 1 September 2026 - 31 August 2027

Planning Basis

This document treats VCT Connect as a 12-month MVP-to-commercial-launch project. The plan uses a lean operating assumptions established for the project: a five-member founding team, 50 million VND of initial funding concentrated in development and launch marketing, no founder compensation during Months 1-4, and gradual commercialization from Month 5 onward.

1. Narrative Project Charter

1.1. Project purpose and justification

VCT Connect is an AI-powered supplier-risk intelligence platform designed for Vietnamese sellers and SMEs sourcing products through 1688, Taobao, Alibaba, and similar Chinese marketplaces. The project addresses a practical problem: smaller buyers often have limited Chinese-language capability, incomplete information about suppliers, difficulty differentiating factories from trading companies, and little time to manually review large volumes of supplier and customer data. The project matters because a poor sourcing decision can lead to defective goods, delivery delays, lost capital, and damage to the seller's own reputation.

When the project is complete, users should be able to submit a supplier or product link and receive a Vietnamese evidence-based risk report containing a supplier summary, factory-versus-trader assessment, risk score, review and anomaly analysis, warning indicators, and recommended questions or checks before ordering. The goal is not to guarantee that a supplier is safe, but to make the decision faster, more transparent, and lower risk.

1.2. Measurable objectives and success criteria

ID	Objective	Success criterion
O1	Deliver a usable MVP by 31 December 2026.	The MVP contains supplier-link input, Vietnamese summary, explainable risk score, factory-vs-trader assessment, review/anomaly analysis, and evidence/warning display; no unresolved critical defects at release.
O2	Validate the product with real users by 28 February 2027.	At least 30 pilot users complete tests; at least 70% rate the report as useful for a sourcing decision; all major accuracy or workflow defects are logged and either corrected or formally deferred.
O3	Launch a paid public beta by 31 March 2027.	Pricing, payment, onboarding, support process, and public beta campaign are operational; first paid users can complete the full supplier-analysis workflow without team assistance.
O4	Reach a stable first-year operating position by 31 August 2027.	Approximately 191 active paid accounts are targeted, monthly revenue reaches about 100.6 million VND, and the product records positive monthly operating results during the final quarter of the project.

1.3. High-level scope

Scope	Definition
Included	Supplier/profile link intake; Vietnamese supplier summary; risk scoring with visible evidence; factory-vs-trading-company assessment; review and anomaly analysis; warning indicators; supplier comparison and saved reports/watchlist; pilot testing; pricing/payment/onboarding; public beta launch; one logistics/intermediary pilot; first-year optimization and closeout.
Excluded	Guaranteeing supplier safety or product quality; physical factory inspection; escrow/payment protection; operating a logistics service; full order management; customs clearance; legal certification of suppliers; replacing sourcing intermediaries; full automation for every Chinese marketplace at launch.

1.4. Key stakeholders

- Project Sponsor/CEO - controls business direction, major budget decisions, pricing, partnerships, and final strategic approvals.
- Five-member founding team - AI, software/product, Chinese supplier intelligence, business development, and growth/customer success.
- Vietnamese online sellers and SME pilot users - primary end users and the main source of product validation.
- China-Vietnam logistics and order intermediaries - potential partners, data contributors, and distribution channels.
- Marketplace and technology providers - external dependencies for supplier-page access, cloud services, AI services, and payment processing.

1.5. High-level requirements

- The platform must accept supplier or product URLs and extract usable supplier information from supported marketplaces.
- Every risk result must be presented in Vietnamese and must show the evidence or signals that contributed to the conclusion.
- The system must distinguish uncertainty from confirmed information and avoid presenting unsupported claims as facts.
- The MVP must support an end-to-end user workflow from link submission to report viewing, comparison, saving, and export/share.
- The system must include basic security, access control, logging, error handling, and data-retention rules suitable for a commercial beta.
- The product must be usable by non-technical Vietnamese sellers without requiring knowledge of Chinese marketplace terminology.

1.6. Assumptions and constraints

Type	Planning statement
Assumptions	Founders can contribute without salary in Months 1-4; public supplier information remains sufficiently

Type	Planning statement
	accessible for an MVP; users are willing to test the product using real supplier links; third-party AI/cloud services remain available; the team can validate Chinese-language interpretation internally.
Constraints	Initial cash funding is limited to 50 million VND; team size is fixed at five during the initial development period; the first release must remain an MVP; marketplace access rules may change; the product cannot perform physical supplier verification; project decisions must balance accuracy, speed, and cash conservation.

1.7. Summary milestones

Milestone	Description	Target date
M1	Project baseline approved	7 Sep 2026
M2	Supplier-risk framework and MVP requirements approved	26 Oct 2026
M3	Integrated MVP ready	31 Dec 2026
M4	Closed pilot completed and major fixes agreed	28 Feb 2027
M5	Paid public beta launched	31 Mar 2027
M6	First intermediary pilot completed	30 Jun 2027
M7	Year-1 stabilization and project closeout	31 Aug 2027

1.8. Initial high-level risks

- Marketplace access or page-structure changes may break supplier-data extraction.
- Incomplete or misleading source data may produce an incorrect or overconfident supplier-risk assessment.
- AI-generated summaries or classifications may be inaccurate and reduce user trust.
- Customer interest may not convert into repeated paid usage at the expected rate.
- Limited initial cash may create pressure to launch before the product is sufficiently stable.

2. Work Breakdown Structure and Activity Sequence

The WBS is deliverable-oriented. Each work package produces an output that can be scheduled, costed, assigned, and tested. The sequence table that follows uses the same WBS codes so that the relationship between scope and schedule remains visible.

WBS	Deliverable / work package	Output
1.0	Project governance and validated requirements	Approved charter, success measures, stakeholder needs, and controlled MVP scope.
1.1	Project baseline	Charter, roles, decision rules, project controls.
1.2	Customer and workflow research	Seller interviews, sourcing workflow map, pain-point evidence.

WBS	Deliverable / work package	Output
1.3	MVP requirements and acceptance criteria	Functional requirements, exclusions, release criteria.
2.0	Supplier intelligence framework	Validated logic for interpreting supplier data and evidence.
2.1	Risk indicator taxonomy	Risk categories, signal definitions, confidence rules.
2.2	Chinese-language and supplier validation	Terminology, factory/trader indicators, review interpretation.
2.3	Evidence and data-source rules	Source hierarchy, missing-data handling, evidence display rules.
3.0	AI risk-analysis engine	Working analytical services used by the application.
3.1	Data extraction and preprocessing	Marketplace parser, normalization, error handling.
3.2	Review and anomaly analysis	Negative-topic extraction, rating/review inconsistencies, warning signals.
3.3	Vietnamese summary generation	Structured Vietnamese supplier and risk summary.
3.4	Factory-vs-trader classification	Classification logic with confidence output.
3.5	Risk scoring and explainability	Weighted scoring, evidence trace, uncertainty display.
4.0	VCT Connect MVP application	Usable browser/web product connecting the analysis engine to users.
4.1	Backend, database, and API	Accounts, report storage, APIs, basic administration.
4.2	Browser extension and web interface	Supplier-link intake, report UI, comparison and save workflow foundation.
4.3	AI-to-product integration	End-to-end report generation and error states.
4.4	QA, security, logging, and release	Testing, access control, monitoring, critical-defect closure.
5.0	Pilot-validated product	Evidence that the MVP works with real users and real supplier links.
5.1	Pilot recruitment and onboarding	Representative test group and test instructions.
5.2	Pilot execution and feedback	Usage sessions, interviews, issue log, usefulness feedback.
5.3	Calibration and corrective fixes	Model/workflow corrections and approved deferred issues.
6.0	Commercial beta launch	Product capable of accepting paying users.
6.1	Pricing, payment, and onboarding	Plans, payment flow, onboarding, support messages.
6.2	Public beta campaign	Launch content, community outreach, acquisition tracking.
6.3	Referral and community partnerships	Referral mechanism and initial community/partner activation.

WBS	Deliverable / work package	Output
7.0	Optimized first-year product	Stabilized product and operating model ready for Year 2.
7.1	Supplier comparison and watchlist	Comparison, saved suppliers/reports, watchlist workflow.
7.2	Reliability and performance improvement	Infrastructure, extraction resilience, response-time improvements.
7.3	Intermediary pilot	One logistics/order-intermediary collaboration pilot.
7.4	Retention and acquisition analysis	Usage, churn, CAC, channel performance, product backlog.
7.5	Annual-plan packaging and closeout	Year-2 recommendations, annual plans, documentation, closure review.

Sequenced project activities

ID	WBS	Activity	Predecessor(s)
A1	1.1	Approve project charter, roles, controls	-
A2	1.2	Interview target sellers and map sourcing workflow	A1
A3	1.3	Freeze MVP requirements and acceptance criteria	A2
A4	2.1	Define supplier-risk indicator taxonomy	A1
A5	2.2-2.3	Validate Chinese terminology, supplier signals, and evidence rules	A4
A6	3.1	Build marketplace extraction and preprocessing prototype	A3, A4
A7	3.2-3.3	Build review analysis and Vietnamese summary prototype	A5, A6
A8	3.4-3.5	Build factory/trader classification and explainable risk score	A7
A9	4.1	Build backend, database, authentication, and report API	A3
A10	4.2	Build browser extension and web report interface	A3, A9
A11	4.3	Integrate AI engine with application workflow	A8, A9, A10
A12	4.4	Complete QA, logging, security checks, and critical fixes	A11
A13	5.1	Recruit and onboard pilot users	A12
A14	5.2	Run closed pilot with real supplier links	A12, A13

ID	WBS	Activity	Predecessor(s)
A15	5.3	Analyse pilot results and correct priority defects	A14
A16	6.1	Implement pricing, payment, onboarding, and support flow	A15
A17	6.2	Launch paid public beta	A16
A18	7.1	Add supplier comparison, saved reports, and watchlist	A17
A19	6.3	Activate referral/community partnerships	A17
A20	7.2	Improve extraction reliability and platform performance	A17
A21	7.3	Run logistics/intermediary partner pilot	A19, A20
A22	7.4	Review retention, churn, acquisition cost, and channel quality	A18, A21
A23	7.5	Prepare annual-plan packaging and Year-2 backlog	A22
A24	7.5	Complete stabilization, documentation, and project closeout	A23

3. Integrated Project Schedule and Budget

3.1. Project schedule

ID	Activity	Dur.	Start	Finish	Pred.	MS
A1	Approve project charter, roles, controls	1 wk	1 Sep 2026	7 Sep 2026	-	M1
A2	Seller interviews and sourcing workflow map	3 wks	8 Sep 2026	28 Sep 2026	A1	
A3	MVP requirements and acceptance criteria	2 wks	29 Sep 2026	12 Oct 2026	A2	
A4	Supplier-risk indicator taxonomy	4 wks	8 Sep 2026	5 Oct 2026	A1	
A5	Chinese terminology, supplier signals, evidence rules	3 wks	6 Oct 2026	26 Oct 2026	A4	M2
A6	Data extraction and preprocessing prototype	4 wks	13 Oct 2026	9 Nov 2026	A3,A4	
A7	Review analysis and Vietnamese	5 wks	27 Oct 2026	30 Nov 2026	A5,A6	

ID	Activity	Dur.	Start	Finish	Pred.	MS
	summary prototype					
A8	Factory/trader classifier and explainable risk score	4 wks	1 Dec 2026	28 Dec 2026	A7	
A9	Backend, database, authentication, report API	6 wks	13 Oct 2026	23 Nov 2026	A3	
A10	Browser extension and web report interface	5 wks	24 Nov 2026	28 Dec 2026	A3,A9	
A11	AI-to-product integration	2 wks	15 Dec 2026	28 Dec 2026	A8,A9,A10	
A12	QA, security, logging, critical fixes	3 days	29 Dec 2026	31 Dec 2026	A11	M3
A13	Pilot recruitment and onboarding	2 wks	4 Jan 2027	15 Jan 2027	A12	
A14	Closed pilot execution	4 wks	18 Jan 2027	12 Feb 2027	A12,A13	
A15	Pilot analysis, calibration, corrective fixes	2 wks	15 Feb 2027	28 Feb 2027	A14	M4
A16	Pricing, payment, onboarding, support flow	2 wks	1 Mar 2027	14 Mar 2027	A15	
A17	Paid public beta launch	2.5 wks	15 Mar 2027	31 Mar 2027	A16	M5
A18	Supplier comparison, saved reports, watchlist	4 wks	1 Apr 2027	30 Apr 2027	A17	
A19	Referral and community partner activation	6 wks	15 Apr 2027	31 May 2027	A17	
A20	Reliability and performance improvement	4 wks	1 May 2027	31 May 2027	A17	
A21	Logistics/ intermediary pilot	4 wks	1 Jun 2027	30 Jun 2027	A19,A20	M6
A22	Retention, churn, CAC, channel analysis	4 wks	1 Jul 2027	31 Jul 2027	A18,A21	
A23	Annual-plan packaging and Year-2 backlog	2 wks	1 Aug 2027	15 Aug 2027	A22	
A24	Stabilization, documentation,	2 wks	16 Aug 2027	31 Aug 2027	A23	M7

ID	Activity	Dur.	Start	Finish	Pred.	MS
	closeout					

3.2. Budget baseline

The budget below covers the same 12-month period as the schedule. It separates fixed project/operating costs from direct variable costs. The first four months use the original 50 million VND seed investment, split between development and customer validation/launch preparation. Founder allowances begin only in Month 5. Later spending is expected to be supported by operating revenue and working capital.

Cost category	Million VND	Assumption / driver
Founder allowances	325.0	Introduced gradually from Month 5; no founder pay in Months 1-4.
Product and AI development	75.5	Development tools, AI prototyping, technical implementation, testing.
Marketing and customer acquisition	83.5	Research recruitment, launch campaigns, communities, referral activity.
Cloud, data, and technical services	43.0	Hosting, storage, API/inference usage not charged directly per report.
Support and administration	19.0	Customer support tools, basic administration, operational materials.
Variable direct service costs	76.2	Approximately 14% of projected Year-1 revenue; AI/data processing, payment fees, report-related variable costs.
TOTAL PROJECT COST BASELINE	622.2	Total first-year cost baseline.

3.3. Monthly cost profile

Month	Main cost-driving work	Fixed	Variable	Total
Sep 2026 (M1)	Requirements, architecture, early research	12.5	0.0	12.5
Oct 2026 (M2)	Extraction/backend/AI prototypes	12.5	0.0	12.5
Nov 2026 (M3)	AI analysis, UI, landing/waitlist	12.5	0.6	13.1
Dec 2026 (M4)	Integration, QA, pilot preparation	12.5	1.4	13.9
Jan 2027 (M5)	Public-beta preparation, pilot support, founder allowances begin	50.0	3.1	53.1
Feb 2027 (M6)	Pilot correction, pricing/onboarding preparation	55.0	5.0	60.0
Mar 2027 (M7)	Paid launch and community expansion	60.0	7.1	67.1
Apr 2027 (M8)	Comparison/watchlist and	65.0	9.1	74.1

Month	Main cost-driving work	Fixed	Variable	Total
	referral growth			
May 2027 (M9)	Reliability and channel optimization	67.0	10.6	77.6
Jun 2027 (M10)	Partner pilot and conversion improvement	70.0	12.0	82.0
Jul 2027 (M11)	Retention/CAC optimization	67.0	13.2	80.2
Aug 2027 (M12)	Stabilization, annual plans, closeout	62.0	14.1	76.1
TOTAL		546.0	76.2	622.2

Major cost drivers are founder allowances after Month 4, product/AI work during the MVP and optimization periods, customer acquisition around the public launch, and variable processing costs that rise with usage. The model intentionally tapers marketing and development spending toward the end of the year as the emphasis moves from acquisition to retention, stability, and Year-2 preparation.

4. Responsibility Assignment Matrix and Risk Register

4.1. RACI responsibility assignment matrix

R = Responsible for doing the work; A = Accountable for final acceptance; C = Consulted; I = Informed. The COO/Software and Product Development Lead also acts as the day-to-day Project Manager for this plan.

Major work area	CEO / BD	CFO / Chinese Intel	CTO / AI	COO / Product-PM	CMO / Growth-CS
Project charter and MVP requirements	A	C	C	R	C
Supplier intelligence and evidence framework	I	A/R	C	C	C
AI analysis engine and risk scoring	I	C	A/R	C	C
Backend, extension, UI, integration, QA	I	C	C	A/R	C
Pilot recruitment and customer feedback	I	C	C	A	R
Pricing, payment, and commercial model	A	C	I	R	C
Public beta marketing and acquisition	A	I	I	C	R
Referral/community/ intermediary partnerships	A/R	C	I	C	C
Reliability, retention analysis, closeout	I	C	C	A/R	C

4.2. Project risk register

ID	Risk	P	I	Exposure	Response	Planned response	Owner
R1	Marketplace access or page structure changes break extraction	4	5	20 - High	Mitigate	Use modular parsers, monitoring, fallback manual/link input, and avoid depending on one marketplace endpoint.	COO
R2	Supplier source data is incomplete, manipulated, or misleading	4	5	20 - High	Mitigate	Use multiple signals, confidence levels, evidence links, missing-data flags, and human review for high-risk cases.	CFO
R3	AI summary or classification is inaccurate or overconfident	3	5	15 - High	Mitigate	Use structured outputs, validation rules, calibrated thresholds, pilot review, and explicit uncertainty statements.	CTO
R4	Pilot users show interest but do not convert to repeated paid usage	4	4	16 - High	Mitigate	Test pricing early, track repeat use, interview drop-offs, narrow the initial segment, and prioritize high-value workflows.	CEO/CMO
R5	Cash shortfall occurs before the product reaches stable revenue	3	5	15 - High	Mitigate	Keep first four months founder-unpaid, apply monthly spending gates, delay non-MVP features, and maintain a rolling cash forecast.	CEO
R6	MVP development slips because scope expands or dependencies are underestimated	3	4	12 - Medium	Avoid / Mitigate	Freeze MVP acceptance criteria, use weekly sprint review, maintain change log, and defer noncritical features to the post-launch backlog.	COO
R7	User or supplier data is exposed through weak security or access control	2	5	10 - Medium	Mitigate	Minimize stored data, apply authentication/role access, encrypted transport/storage where applicable, logging, and security review before beta.	COO
R8	Key-person dependency slows work if one	4	3	12 - Medium	Mitigate	Maintain documentation, code review,	COO

ID	Risk	P	I	Exposure	Response	Planned response	Owner
	founder becomes unavailable					shared repositories/credentials, and cross-training for critical workflows.	
R9	Business, AI, and software priorities conflict and delay decisions	3	3	9 - Medium	Mitigate	Use the RACI, weekly product-priority review, defined decision owner, and written escalation path to the CEO.	COO
R10	Supplier-risk wording creates reputational or legal complaints	2	5	10 - Medium	Avoid / Mitigate	Avoid unsupported fraud claims, show evidence and confidence, use neutral risk language, maintain correction/appeal process, and include clear limitations.	CEO/CFO

4.3. Effect of the highest-priority risks

The most serious risks are not independent. If marketplace access becomes unreliable, the team may lose data coverage, which in turn reduces report quality. If report quality falls, customer trust and paid conversion may also fall. A cash shortfall would then reduce the team's ability to correct the technical problem. For that reason, the plan treats data resilience, explainability, early customer validation, and spending control as linked controls rather than separate risk responses.

The Project Manager should review the risk register every two weeks during MVP development and monthly after launch. Any risk with an exposure score of 15 or more should have an active owner, a current response action, and a decision date. New risks or material changes in probability or impact should be added to the register and reflected in the schedule or budget baseline when necessary.

5. Internal Consistency Check

Alignment	How it is maintained
Scope -> WBS	Every included scope item is represented by a WBS deliverable; excluded activities such as physical inspection and logistics operations are not budgeted as project work.
WBS -> Schedule	Each scheduled activity references a WBS code and has a predecessor relationship where dependency exists.
Schedule -> Budget	The cost profile follows the same 12-month period. The 50M VND seed spend occurs in the first four months, founder allowances begin in Month 5, and usage-based costs rise after pilot and launch.
WBS/Schedule -> RACI	Major work areas in the RACI correspond to the same deliverables used in the WBS and schedule.
Risk -> Controls	High-priority risks have named owners and response actions that affect scope control, QA, schedule, or budget decisions.